

the definition of `setting_values()`. The main purpose of this operator is to define a class member from outside the class definition. First a class named `Rect` is declared, with two variables (of type integer) also declared within it. These two variables are `x` and `y`, respectively. The function `area()` has been defined within the definition of the class 'Rect'. Further, the `setting_values` method has only its prototype declared within the class but is actually defined outside of it.

Further, the scope resolution operator is used for specifying the function which is actually a member of the class 'Rect' and only its prototype is declared within the class.

The scope resolution operator also specifies the class to which the member being declared belongs. Two parameters, `a` and `b`, of the type `int` within the `setting_values` method are passed. The values are then stored within `x` and `y` in the method declaration part as shown above.

Next we come to the main method or the main function definition part. An object of the type 'Rect' is then instantiated. This object is named as 'rec'. The object then accesses the `setting_values` method by the `(.)` operator and two numerical values (7, 8) are passed. Then the method `area()` is called using the name of object and the `(.)` operator. Multiplication is done based on these two values stored in the variables `x` and `y`. According to the prototype of the method `area()`, it will return an integer value. In this case, the result of multiplication will be returned. The returned value is printed using `cout` and `<<`.